The Ten Perfections for Little Readers

Ten good things the Buddha made perfect, with Sumedha's pictures and the old stories, told for children of about seven



“Na sasassa tilā atthi, na muggā napi taṇḍulā; iminā agginā pakkaṃ, mamaṃ bhutvā vane vasā”: The hare has no sesame, no beans and no rice. Eat me, cooked on this fire, and live on in the forest. (Jātaka 316)

Every Pali word is followed by its English in brackets. A quiz follows every two chapters; the answers are at the back.

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How to read this book

This book is for Anna, who is seven, and for other children of about that age. A child can read it alone, or an older person can read it aloud, a chapter at a time.

It tells about ten good things. The Buddha made each of them perfect, in many, many lives, before he became the Buddha. The old books call them the ten *pāramī* (perfections).

Where this book began. This book was inspired by *The Perfections Leading to Enlightenment* by Sujin Boriharnwanaket, translated by Nina van Gorkom, a book about the ten perfections for grown-ups. Her book draws on the old Pali books, and this one goes to the same old books for its stories and its Pali lines. There is a bigger book for older children, *The Ten Perfections for Young Readers*, that follows her book closely.

Pali words. The Buddha's words were kept in a language called Pali. Some Pali words are in this book. Every time one comes, its English is next to it in brackets, like this: *dāna* (giving). You do not have to remember the Pali to understand the page. But if you do remember some, you will know real words from the Buddha's own books.

Saying the words. A line over a letter makes it long. *ā* sounds like the "a" in "father". *ī* sounds like the "ee" in "see". *ū* sounds like the "oo" in "moon". A dot under a letter (*ṭ*, *ḍ*, *ṇ*) means the tongue curls back a little. *ñ* sounds like the "ny" in "canyon". *ṃ* sounds like "ng". So *paññā* is said "pan-nyaa" and *mettā* is said "met-taa".

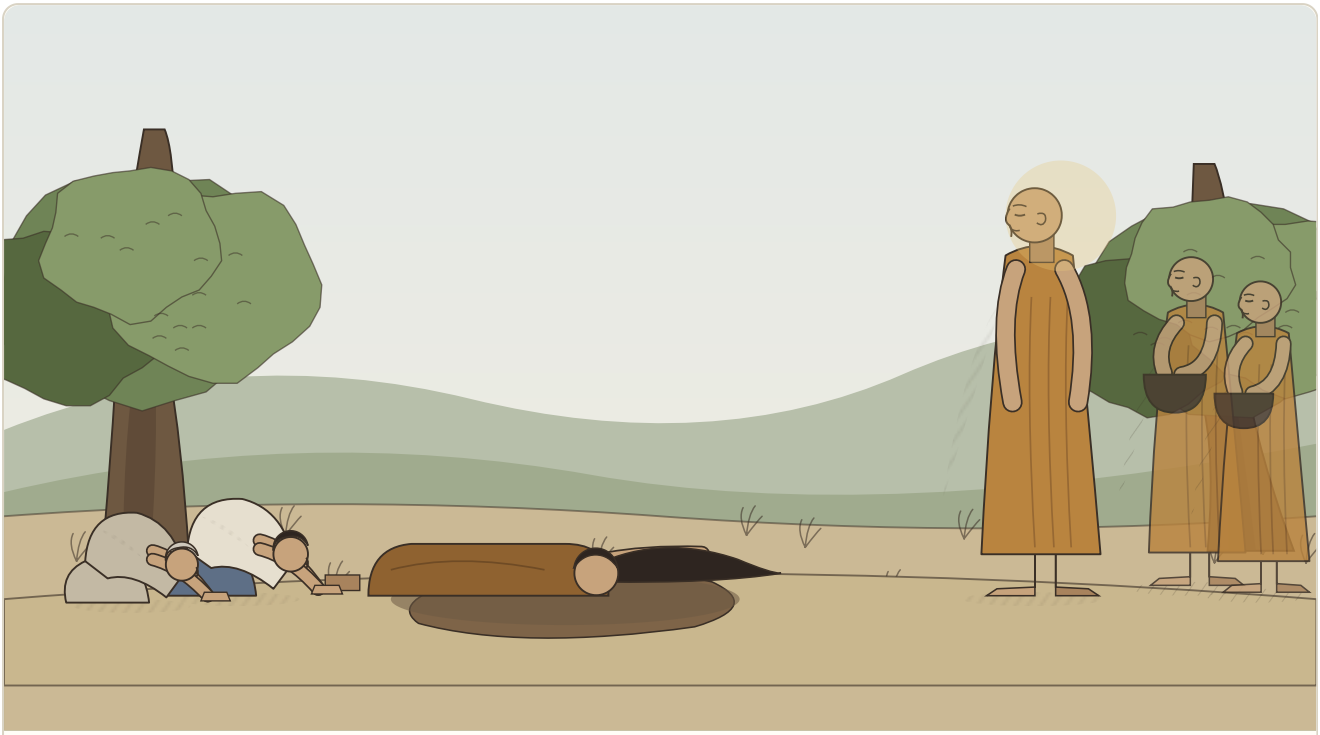
The lines under the pictures. Under every picture there is a line in Pali from the Buddha's own books, and after it the meaning in plain English. The Pali is exactly as it stands in the old books. The English was written for this book, and the name of the old book is given at the end of the line.

Hard words. Some English words in this book are hard. The first time a hard word is met in a chapter it has a small number after it, like this: hermit[3]. Its meaning is given at the end of the chapter, under "Hard words in this chapter", and all the hard words are listed together at the back, after the word list. In the web edition, tapping or clicking on the word shows its meaning.

Quizzes. After every two chapters there is a short quiz.

Where the stories come from. All the stories are old. The story of Sumedha comes from the *Buddhavaṃsa* (the Story of the Buddhas). The other stories come from the *Jātaka* (birth stories) and the *Cariyāpiṭaka* (Basket of Conduct). All three are books of the *Tipiṭaka* (the Three Baskets), the oldest collection of the Buddha's teaching. The Buddha told these stories himself. In each one he is the *Bodhisatta* (the Buddha-to-be), the one who is working, life after life, to become a Buddha. The last pages of this book say where each story is found.

Introduction. Sumedha finds the ten



“Kiṃ me ekena tiṇṇena, purisena thāmadassinā; sabbaññutaṃ pāpuṇitvā, santāressaṃ sadevakaṃ”: What good is it for me to cross over alone, a man who knows his own strength? I will reach full knowledge and carry the whole world across. (Buddhavaṃsa 2)

Long, long ago there was a young man named Sumedha. He was very rich. But he saw that everyone gets old, everyone gets ill, and everyone dies. He did not want to go round and round in that for ever. So he gave away all his riches and went to live in the mountains. There he trained his mind until it was calm and strong.

At that time there was a Buddha in the world. His name was Dīpaṅkara. One day Sumedha heard that the Buddha Dīpaṅkara was coming to a town nearby. The people were making the road smooth for him. Sumedha asked for a piece of the road to make smooth too. But before he had finished, the Buddha came.

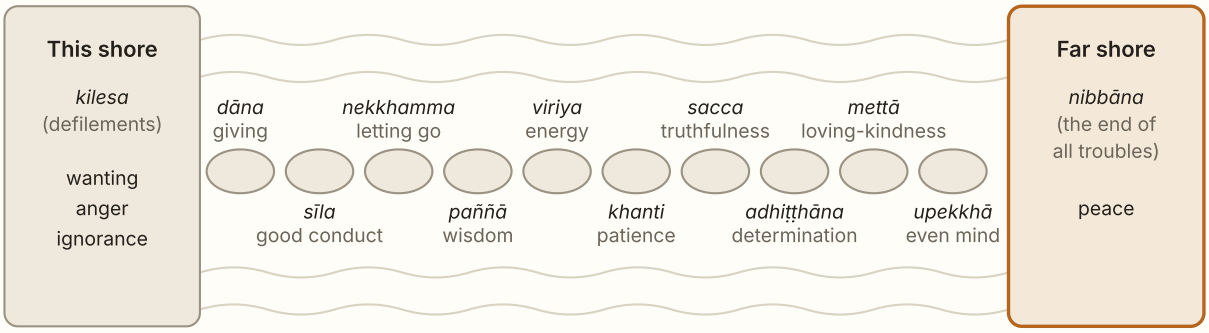
There was still mud on Sumedha’s piece of road. So Sumedha lay down in the mud. He spread his long hair over it. He thought: let the Buddha and his monks[1] walk over me, so that their feet do not touch the mud.

As he lay there, Sumedha knew that he could end all his own troubles that very day, if he wished. But he thought: what good is it to cross over alone? I will become a Buddha myself, and I will carry the whole world across.

The Buddha Dīpaṅkara stood by his head. He said to the people: this man will become a Buddha. His name will be Gotama.

The ten. Then Sumedha asked himself: what does a person need, to become a Buddha? He looked, and he found ten things. He found them one by one, and for each one he thought of a picture. The first was *dāna* (giving). Then came *sīla* (good conduct), *nekkhamma* (letting go), *paññā* (wisdom), *viriya* (energy[2]), *khanti* (patience), *sacca* (truthfulness[3]), *adhiṭṭhāna* (determination[4]), *mettā* (loving-kindness[5]) and *upekkhā* (even-mindedness[6]). These are the ten *pāramī* (perfections[7]). This book has one chapter for each of them, and each chapter tells Sumedha's picture for it.

A *pāramī* (perfection) is a good thing made as big and as strong as it can be. The *Bodhisatta* (the Buddha-to-be) made all ten perfect. It took him a time so long that nobody can count it: four uncountable ages and a hundred thousand ages more.



"Sabbe dhammā anattā ti, yadā paññāya passati; atha nibbindati dukkhe, esa maggo visuddhiyā": All things are not self. When a person sees this with wisdom, he turns away from suffering. This is the path to purity. (Dhammapada 279)

The old teachers also say that the word *pāramī* (perfection) makes people think of a river. On this side of the river are the troubles of the mind: *lobha* (wanting), *dosa* (anger) and *moha* (ignorance[8]). On the far side is *nibbāna* (the end of all troubles). The ten perfections carry a person across.

Mind moments. The Pali word for the mind is *citta* (mind). A *citta* (mind) lasts one moment. There is a moment of seeing. It goes. There is a moment of hearing. It goes. There is a moment of thinking. It goes. A *citta* (mind) can be *kusala* (good) or *akusala* (bad). All ten perfections are *kusala* (good) moments of mind.

What Anna says. Anna is seven. She knows three Pali words that the Buddha said: *sabbe dhammā anattā* (all things are not self). What does that mean?

Think of a cart. A cart has wheels, a floor and a pole for the ox. Take away the wheels. Take away the floor. Take away the pole. Where is the cart? There is no cart left over. "Cart" is only a name for the parts when they are together. A nun[9] named Vajirā, who had learnt from the Buddha, said

that a person is like that. A person is a body and a mind. And the mind is one moment after another. “Anna” is a name for all of that. There is no little Anna inside who stays the same and owns it all. That is *anattā* (not self).

This matters for the perfections. When there is giving, nobody inside does the giving. There is a good moment of mind. It gives, and then it is gone. The old teachers say that a perfection is giving, or patience, or any of the ten, that is not spoilt by wanting, by pride, or by the wrong idea of a self. The *Bodhisatta* (the Buddha-to-be) did good without thinking “I am the good one”. Every chapter in this book ends by looking at that.

HARD WORDS IN THIS CHAPTER

1. **monk**: a man who has left home to follow the Buddha's rule of life
2. **energy**: effort; the strength that keeps on going
3. **truthfulness**: always telling the truth and keeping to it
4. **determination**: making up one's mind firmly and keeping to it
5. **loving-kindness**: wishing others well; friendliness to everyone
6. **even-mindedness**: having a mind that stays level and calm whatever happens
7. **perfection**: a good quality made as full and strong as it can be
8. **ignorance**: not knowing; not understanding what is really there
9. **nun**: a woman who has left home to follow the Buddha's rule of life

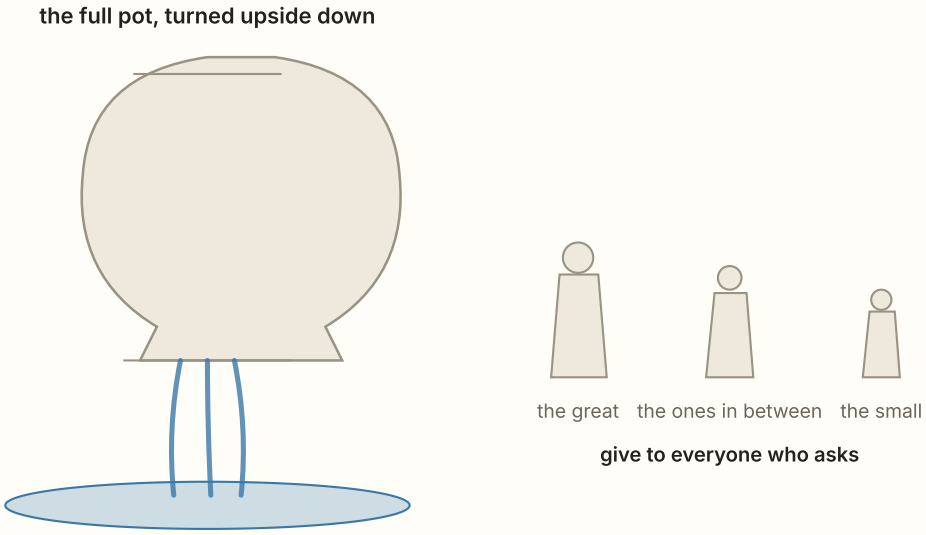
Chapter 1. Dāna (giving)



“Na sasassa tilā atthi, na muggā napi taṇḍulā; iminā agginā pakkaṃ, mamaṃ bhutvā vane vasā”: The hare has no sesame, no beans and no rice. Eat me, cooked on this fire, and live on in the forest. (Jātaka 316)

Dāna (giving) means giving something away to help someone else. It can be food. It can be a toy. It can be a kind word, or a bit of time. When there is giving, the mind lets go. For that one moment there is no holding on.

Sumedha’s picture. Sumedha thought of a water pot. When a full pot is turned upside down, all the water pours out. The pot keeps none of it back. Sumedha said: give like that pot. Give to everyone who asks, the great and the small and the ones in between, and keep nothing back.



"Yathāpi kumbho sampuṇṇo, yassa kassaci adhokato; vamatevudakaṃ nissesaṃ, na tattha parirakkhati": Like a full pot that is turned upside down: it pours out all its water and keeps none back. (Buddhavaṃsa 2)

The story of the wise hare. Once the *Bodhisatta* (the Buddha-to-be) was born as a hare. He lived in a forest by a river. He had three friends: a monkey, a jackal and an otter. The hare was wise, and the three friends listened to him. He told them: do no harm, and give to those who ask.

One evening the hare looked up at the moon. It was full. He told his friends that the next day was the *uposatha* (the holy day), and that if anyone came asking for food, they should give him their own food before they ate.

The next day the otter found seven fish. The jackal found some meat and a pot of milk curds. The monkey found ripe mangoes. They put their food by and waited. The hare had nothing but grass, and nobody eats grass. He thought: if someone comes asking, I will give him my own body.

Sakka, the king of the *devas* (heavenly beings[1]), knew that thought. He wanted to see if it was real. So he came down to the forest dressed as a brahmin[2] (a priest), and he went from one friend to the next, asking for food. The otter offered his fish. The jackal offered his meat and curds. The monkey offered his mangoes. Each time the brahmin said he would eat later, and went on. Then he came to the hare.

The hare was glad. He told the brahmin to light a fire. The brahmin did. Then the hare shook himself three times, so that any tiny creatures in his fur could get away and not be burnt. And he jumped into the fire.

But the fire did not burn him. It felt cool, like cold water. The hare looked round and asked the brahmin why. Then Sakka showed who he really was. He said he had come to test the hare, and that the hare's gift would be known for ever. He squeezed a mountain in his hand, and with its juice he drew a hare on the moon. The old books say the hare is there still.

Three sizes of giving. The old teachers say giving has three sizes. Giving a thing is the small size. Giving a part of one's own body is the middle size. Giving one's own life, as the hare did, is the biggest size of all.

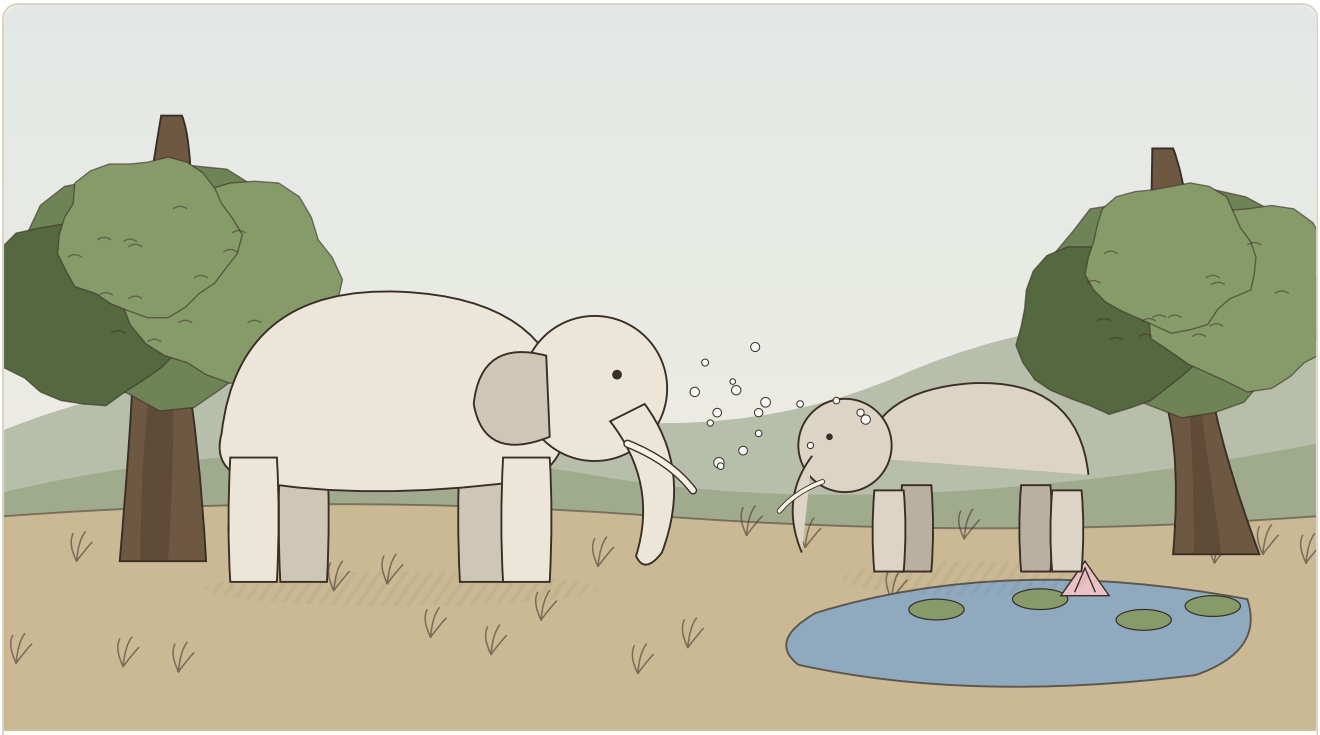
Anna gives. Anna has two sweets. Her friend has none. Anna gives one away. That is *dāna* (giving). It is small. But it is the same kind of thing the hare did. Giving starts small, and it grows every time it is done.

No one inside. Who gave the sweet? Anna, people say. But look closer. There was a good moment of mind. It saw the friend. It let go of the sweet. It moved the hand. Then that moment was gone, and a new one came. There was no little Anna inside the moment, doing the giving. The giving was done by a *kusala citta* (good mind). Anna says: *sabbe dhammā anattā* (all things are not self). And the good deed[3] is not lost. It is *kamma* (a deed), and *kamma* (a deed) brings its fruit later, as a seed brings a fruit.

HARD WORDS IN THIS CHAPTER

1. **being**: any living creature: a person, an animal, a heavenly being
2. **brahmin**: a man of the priestly class in ancient India
3. **deed**: something done; an act, good or bad

Chapter 2. Sīla (good conduct)



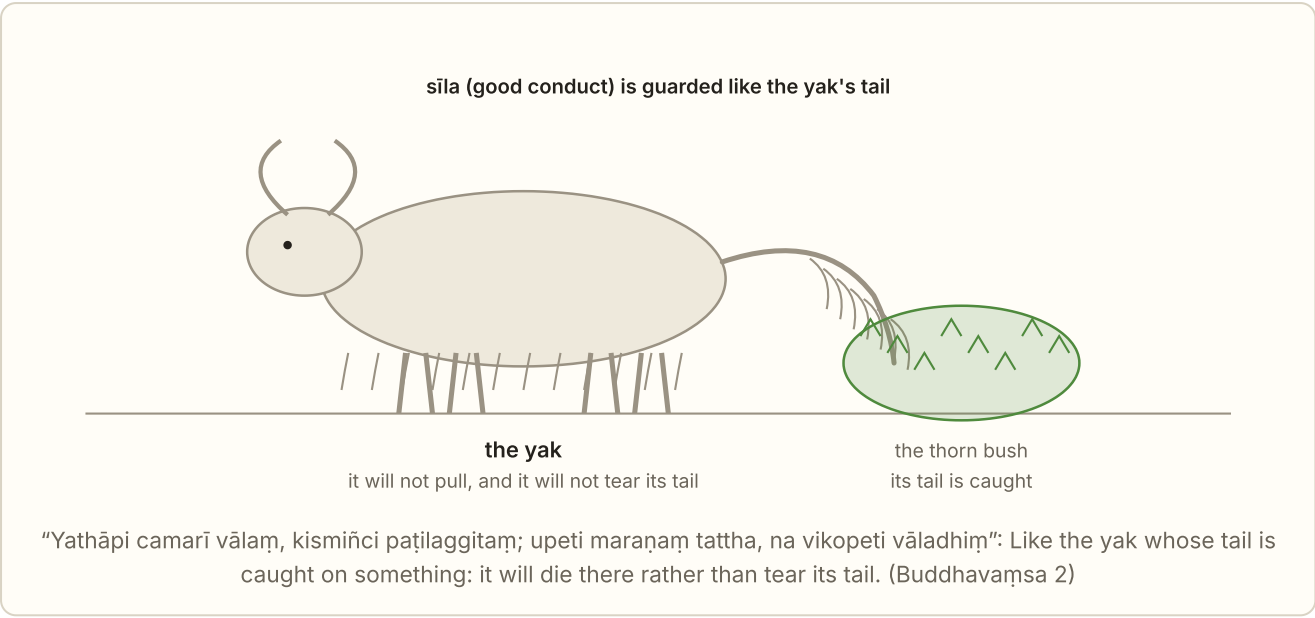
"Mātā me sā mahārāja, andhā apariṇāyikā": Great king, she is my mother. She is blind, and she has no one to lead her. (Jātaka 455)

Sīla (good conduct) means not hurting anyone by what one does or says. The Buddha gave five rules for it:

1. not to kill any living being[1], not even an ant
2. not to take what is not given
3. not to do wrong with someone else's husband or wife
4. not to tell lies
5. not to drink alcohol

Two helpers. Two things in the mind keep the rules. One is *hiri* (shame): the mind does not want to do a dirty thing. The other is *ottappa* (fear of doing wrong): the mind sees what a bad deed[2] brings later, and draws back. When these two are there, the rules are kept without any trouble.

Sumedha's picture. Sumedha thought of a yak. A yak is a big mountain ox with a long, beautiful tail. If its tail gets caught in a bush, the yak will not pull. It would rather die there than tear its tail. Sumedha said: guard good conduct like that, in every life, as the yak guards its tail.



"Yathāpi camarī vālaṃ, kismiñci paṭilaggitaṃ; upeti maraṇaṃ tattha, na vikopeti vāladhiṃ": Like the yak whose tail is caught on something: it will die there rather than tear its tail. (Buddhavaṃsa 2)

The story of the elephant who looked after his mother. Once the *Bodhisatta* (the Buddha-to-be) was born as a great white elephant. He lived in the forest with his mother. His mother was blind. Every day the elephant brought her sweet fruit and lotus[3] roots, and he found her cool water.

One day a man got lost in the forest. He cried and cried. The elephant heard him and led him out to the road. But the man was not grateful. He went to the king and said: in the forest there is a splendid elephant, fit for a king. The king sent his elephant trainers to catch it.

The elephant saw the men coming with ropes. He was very strong. He could have crushed them all. But he thought: if I fight, I will hurt them, and my *sīla* (good conduct) will be broken. So he stood still and let them tie him up.

They took him to the king's city and put him in a fine stable with sweet food. He would not eat. The king came and asked him why. The elephant said that his mother was blind and alone in the forest, and that nobody was there to feed her. The king was moved. He said: set this great elephant free, who cares for his mother.

The elephant went straight back. He filled his trunk with water and sprinkled it over his mother. She thought it was rain. Then he spoke, and she knew that her son had come home.

Anna and the ant. There is an ant on the table. Anna could squash it. She does not. She lets it walk away. That is *sīla* (good conduct). And the ant gets a gift too: it is safe. The Buddha said that a person who does not kill gives safety to every living being.

No one inside. Who kept the rule? There was a moment of mind with *hiri* (shame) and *ottappa* (fear of doing wrong) in it. It did not move the hand. Then it was gone. Nobody inside Anna keeps the rules in a box. The rules are kept one moment at a time. When the next moment comes, they have to be kept again.

HARD WORDS IN THIS CHAPTER

1. **being**: any living creature: a person, an animal, a heavenly being
2. **deed**: something done; an act, good or bad
3. **lotus**: a water flower that grows up from the mud and opens clean above the water

Quiz 1 (chapters 1 and 2)

The answers are at the back.

1. What did the hare give to the brahmin (the priest)?
    - (a) seven fish
    - (b) ripe mangoes
    - (c) his own body
2. What was Sumedha's picture for *dāna* (giving)?
    - (a) a full pot turned upside down
    - (b) a lion
    - (c) a mountain
3. True or false: the fire burnt the hare.
4. Why did the elephant let the king's men tie him up?
    - (a) he was too weak to fight
    - (b) he did not want to break his *sīla* (good conduct)
    - (c) he wanted to live in the city
5. Which animal did Sumedha think of for *sīla* (good conduct)?
    - (a) a monkey
    - (b) a yak that will not tear its tail
    - (c) a quail
6. True or false: *hiri* (shame) and *ottappa* (fear of doing wrong) help the mind to keep the rules.

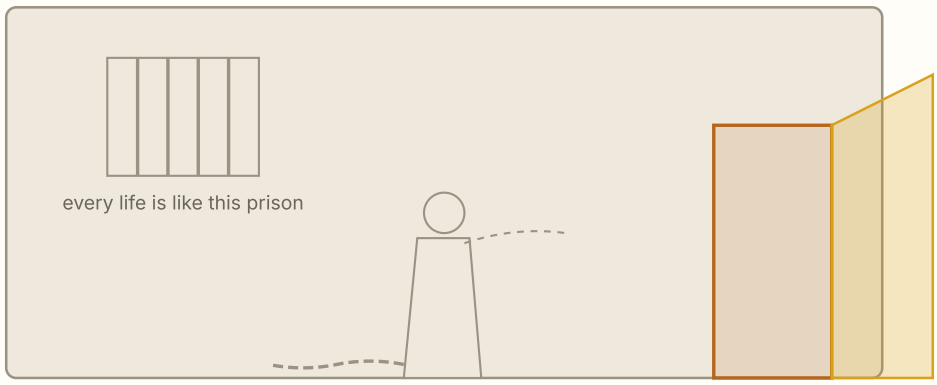
Chapter 3. Nekkhamma (letting go)



"Ussāvabinduṃ sūriyātape, patitaṃ disvāna saṃvijiṃ": When I saw a dewdrop fall in the heat of the sun, I was shaken. (Cariyāpiṭaka 3.1)

Nekkhamma (letting go) means not chasing after nice things all the time: nice sights, nice sounds, nice smells, nice tastes, nice things to touch. It means being happy with enough. A monk[1] lets go of his home. A child can let go of a second piece of cake.

Sumedha's picture. Sumedha thought of a man locked in a prison for a long time. The man does not love the prison. He does not want to stay. He only looks for the way out. Sumedha said: see every life like that prison, and look for the way out.



he does not love the prison; he only looks for the way out

"Yathā andughare puriso, ciravuttho dukhaṭṭito; na tattha rāgaṃ janesi, muttiṃyeva gavesati": Like a man long shut in a prison, worn down by suffering: he does not love the place; he looks only for the way out. (Buddhavaṃsa 2)

The story of Prince Yudhañjaya. Once the *Bodhisatta* (the Buddha-to-be) was a prince named Yudhañjaya. He was the king's eldest son, and one day he would be king. He had everything a prince could want.

One morning he drove out early to the park. The sun was just coming up. On every blade of grass and on every spider's web there hung drops of dew. They shone like pearls. The prince looked at them and was happy.

Then the sun rose higher. The dewdrops grew smaller. One by one they were gone. The prince looked, and his heart was shaken. He thought: these drops were here, and now they are not. Everything is like that. My own life is like that.

He went to his mother and father and bowed to them. He asked to leave the palace and live in the forest as a hermit[2]. They cried. The whole city begged him to stay and be king. But the prince let the kingdom go. He was not angry with his parents, and he did not hate the palace. He only wanted something better than all of it: to become a Buddha. His younger brother went with him, and the two of them lived in the Himalaya mountains.

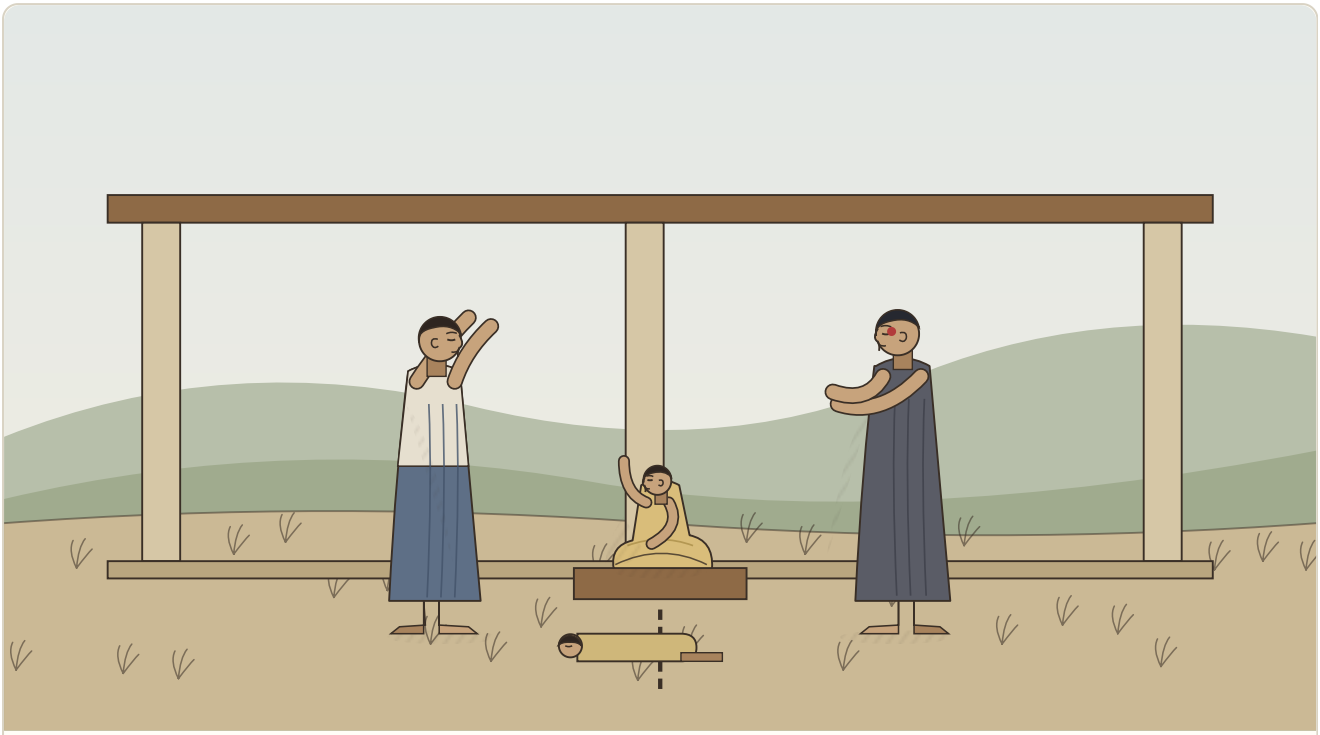
Anna and the second piece. There is cake. Anna has had one piece. It was lovely. There is one piece left. Her mouth wants it. But she is full. She leaves it. That is *nekkhamma* (letting go). It is a tiny bit of what the prince did.

No one inside. The wanting that came for the cake was *lobha* (wanting). It came. It went. It was not Anna. It was a visitor. When *lobha* (wanting) is seen as a visitor that comes and goes, it is easier to let it go. Anna says: *sabbe dhammā anattā* (all things are not self).

HARD WORDS IN THIS CHAPTER

1. **monk**: a man who has left home to follow the Buddha's rule of life
2. **hermit**: a person who lives alone, away from other people

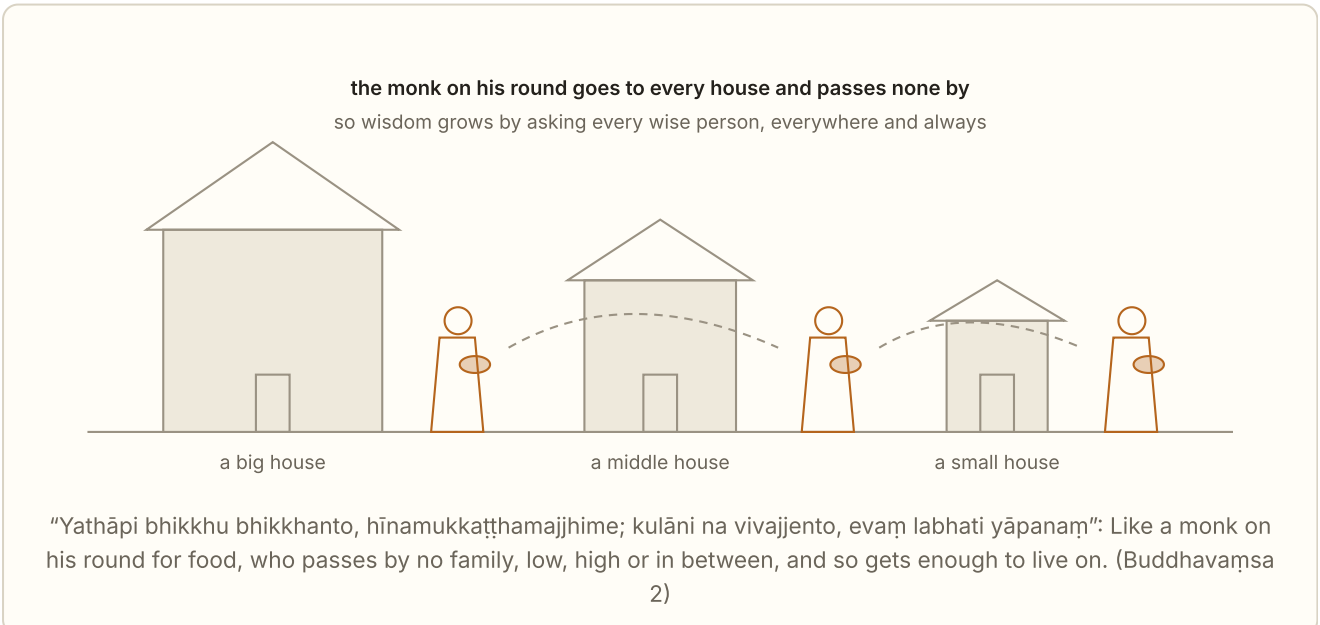
Chapter 4. Paññā (wisdom)



"Paññā lokasmi pajjoto": Wisdom is the light in the world. (Saṃyutta Nikāya 1.80)

Paññā (wisdom) means seeing things as they really are. Without it, the other nine cannot do their work well. The Buddha said that wisdom is the light in the world. A lamp in a dark room shows what is there. Wisdom is like that lamp.

Sumedha's picture. Sumedha thought of a monk[1] on his morning walk for food. The monk goes to every house, big or small, rich or poor. He passes none of them by. So he gets enough to eat. Sumedha said: go to wise people like that, everywhere and always, and ask them questions. That is how wisdom grows.



"Yathāpi bhikkhu bhikkhanto, hīnamukkaṭṭhamajjhime; kulāni na vivajjento, evaṃ labhati yāpanaṃ": Like a monk on his round for food, who passes by no family, low, high or in between, and so gets enough to live on. (Buddhavaṃsa 2)

The story of the boy Mahosadha. Once the *Bodhisatta* (the Buddha-to-be) was born as a boy named Mahosadha. When he was seven years old he was already so wise that people came to him with their quarrels. Here is one of them.

A woman went to a pond to wash, and laid her baby down on the bank. A *yakkhinī* (a wicked spirit) saw the baby and wanted to eat it. She came in the shape of a woman and offered to hold the baby while the mother washed. Then she ran off with it. The mother ran after her and caught her. Each of them said: this is my child.

They came to Mahosadha. He listened. Then he drew a line on the ground and laid the baby across it. He told the *yakkhinī* (the wicked spirit) to take the baby's hands and the mother to take its feet, and he said: pull. Whoever pulls the baby over the line can have it.

They pulled. The baby cried out in pain. The mother could not bear to hurt her child. She let go, and stood there weeping. The *yakkhinī* (the wicked spirit) held on and kept pulling.

Mahosadha asked the people: whose heart is soft for a child, the mother's or a stranger's? They said: the mother's. He said: then this one is the mother. He gave her the baby. And he showed everyone that the other was a *yakkhinī* (a wicked spirit): her eyes were red and did not blink, and she had no shadow. He made her promise to keep the five rules, and sent her away.

Mahosadha was not at the pond. He did not see what happened there. But he knew what a mother's love is like, and he knew how to make it show itself. That is *paññā* (wisdom): seeing what is really so.

Anna learns. Anna cannot see inside her mind with her eyes. But she can learn what is there. Seeing is one thing. Hearing is another. Liking is another. Anger is another. Learning to tell them apart is the beginning of *paññā* (wisdom). It comes from listening and asking, just as Sumedha said.

No one inside. *Paññā* (wisdom) is not a person either. It is a good quality that comes up with a moment of mind, sees, and goes. The clearest thing it sees is this: there is no self in here. There are only moments, coming and going. Anna says: *sabbe dhammā anattā* (all things are not self).

HARD WORDS IN THIS CHAPTER

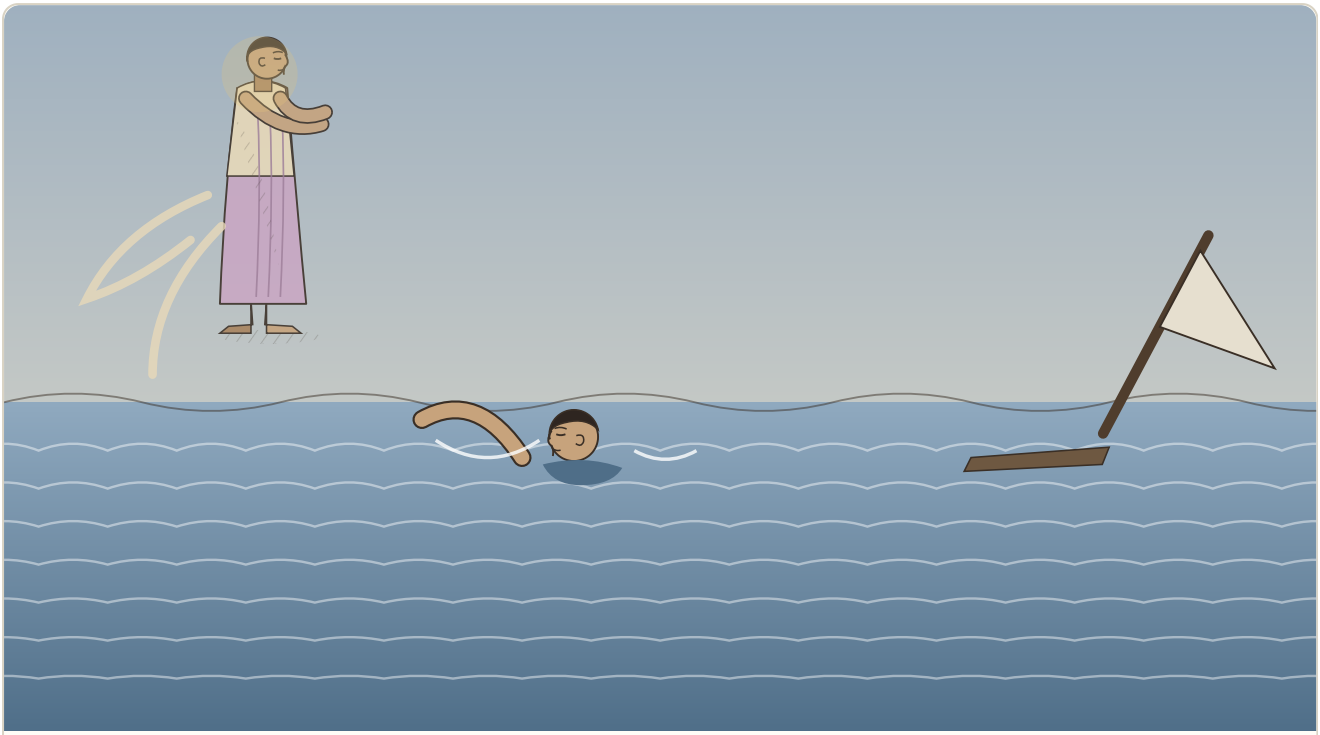
1. **monk**: a man who has left home to follow the Buddha's rule of life

Quiz 2 (chapters 3 and 4)

The answers are at the back.

1. What did Prince Yudhañjaya see that made him leave the palace?
    - (a) a tiger
    - (b) dewdrops drying up in the sun
    - (c) a bag of gold
2. What was Sumedha's picture for *nekkhamma* (letting go)?
    - (a) a man who wants to get out of prison
    - (b) a water pot
    - (c) the earth
3. True or false: Prince Yudhañjaya left because he hated his mother and father.
4. How did Mahosadha find the real mother?
    - (a) he asked the baby
    - (b) the real mother let go so that the baby would not be hurt
    - (c) he looked in a book
5. How old was Mahosadha when he judged this case?
    - (a) seven
    - (b) seventeen
    - (c) seventy
6. True or false: the Buddha said that wisdom is the light in the world.

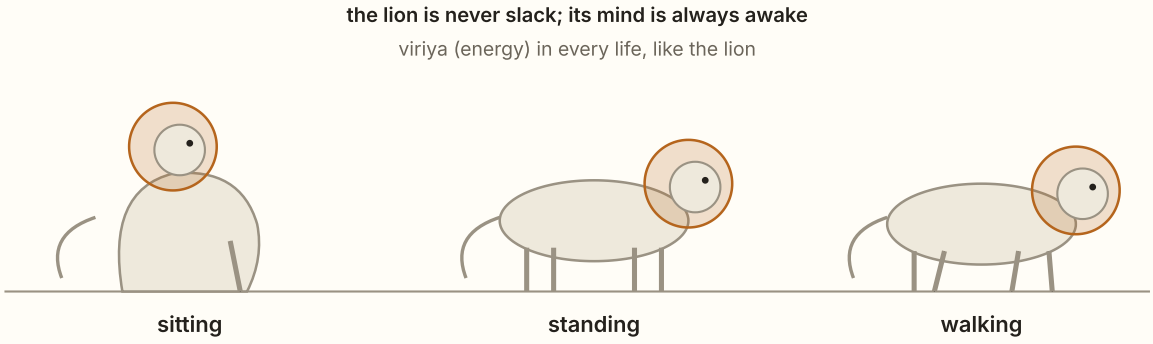
Chapter 5. Viriya (energy)



"Vāyametheva puriso, na nibbindeyya paṇḍito": A person should keep on striving. A wise person does not give up. (Jātaka 539)

Viriya (energy[1]) means effort. It is the strength in the mind that keeps going, and does not give up, and does not get lazy. The Buddha said that by energy a person gets past suffering[2].

Sumedha's picture. Sumedha thought of a lion. Whether the lion sits, or stands, or walks, it is never slack. Its mind is always awake. Sumedha said: keep up firm energy like the lion, in every life.



"Yathāpi sīho migarājā, nisajjaṭṭhānacaṅkame; alīnavīriyo hoti, paggahitamano sadā": Like the lion, king of beasts: sitting, standing or walking, it is never slack in energy, and its mind is always alert. (Buddhavaṃsa 2)

The story of Prince Mahājanaka. Once the *Bodhisatta* (the Buddha-to-be) was a prince named Mahājanaka. His father had been a king, but his uncle took the kingdom, and the prince grew up far away with his mother. When he was grown, he wanted to win the kingdom back. So he got on a ship with goods to sell, to earn money for it.

In the middle of the ocean the ship broke apart. The people on it screamed and wept. Mahājanaka did not scream. He ate until he was full, so that he would have strength. He rubbed oil on his body, so that the water would not make him cold. Then he climbed the mast and jumped as far out as he could, away from the sinking ship and the hungry fish. And he began to swim.

He swam all day. He swam all night. He swam for seven days. There was no land anywhere.

A goddess of the sea named Maṇimekhalā saw him. She asked him who he was, swimming in the middle of the ocean with no shore in sight, and what the use of it was. She said he would die before he reached land.

Mahājanaka answered that a person should do what a person can do. Someone who makes an effort has nothing to be sorry for, even if he fails. And he said: I will go on striving, as far as I can and as hard as I can.

The goddess was pleased. She lifted him out of the water and carried him through the air to his own country. She laid him down, asleep, in a mango grove. In the end he became king there.

Energy for good and energy for bad. Energy is in bad moments too. A person can work very hard to grab something he wants, or to get back at someone. That is not the perfection[3]. The perfection of *viriya* (energy) is effort for *kusala* (good).

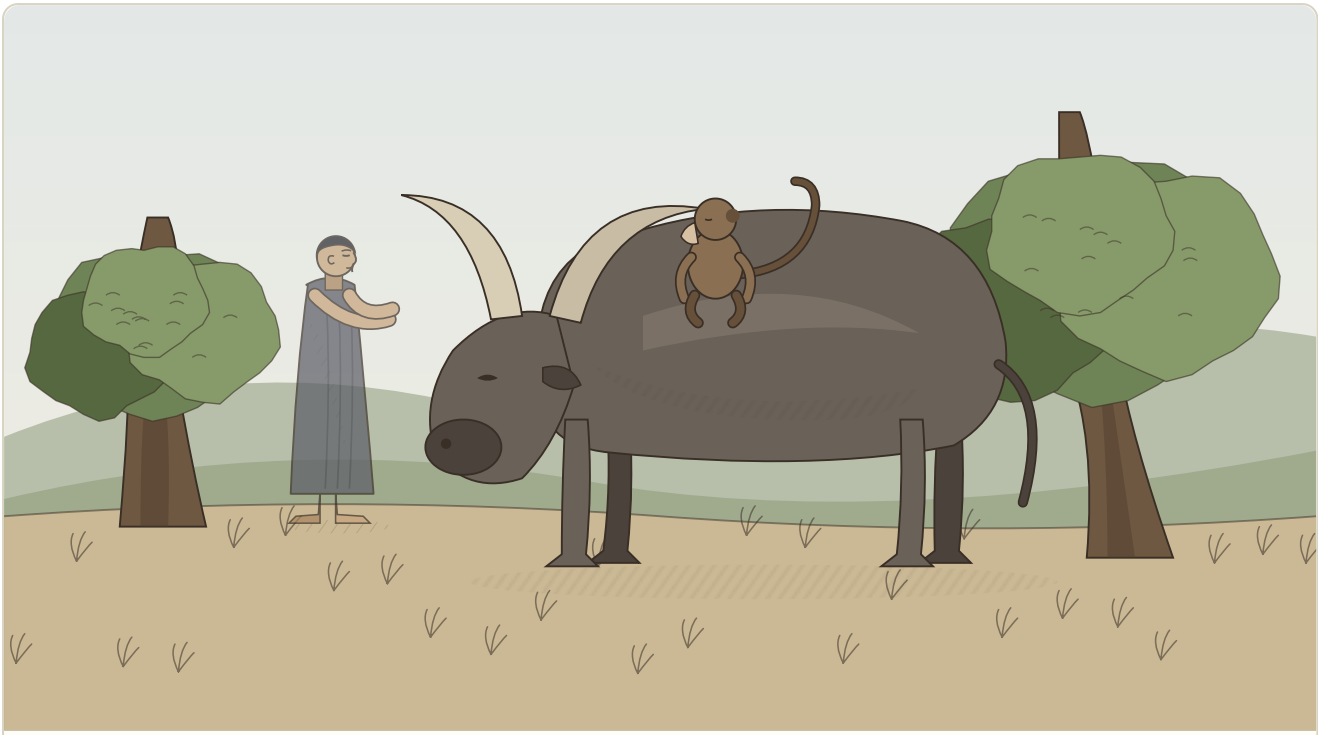
Anna keeps going. Anna is tidying her room. She is tired. She wants to stop. She puts away one more thing. Then one more. That is *viriya* (energy). The prince swam for seven days. Anna puts away one more thing. Both are the same kind of thing.

No one inside. Who swam? Mahājanaka, the story says. But the arm moves because a moment of mind with *viriya* (energy) in it moves the arm. Then that moment is gone. The next moment has to have energy too, or the arm stops. Nobody inside pushes. There is energy, moment after moment, and each moment helps the next one to come.

HARD WORDS IN THIS CHAPTER

1. **energy**: effort; the strength that keeps on going
2. **suffering**: pain and trouble; anything that cannot give lasting happiness
3. **perfection**: a good quality made as full and strong as it can be

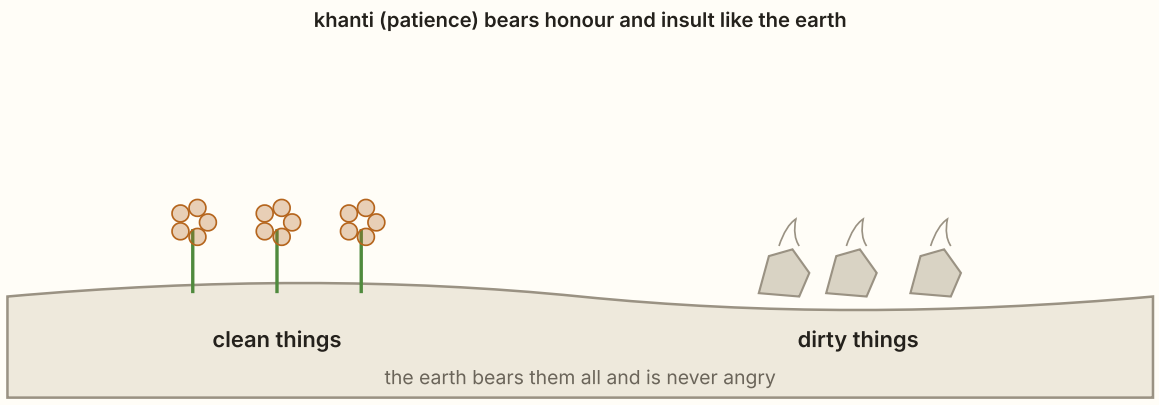
Chapter 6. Khanti (patience)



"Yadihaṃ tassa pakuppeyyaṃ, tato hīnataro bhave; sīlañca me pabhijjeyya, viññū ca garaheyyu maṃ": If I were angry with him, I would be lower than he is. My good conduct would break, and the wise would blame me. (Cariyāpiṭaka 2.5)

Khanti (patience) means putting up with things without getting angry. Hot weather. Cold weather. A long wait. A mosquito. Someone being unkind. The Buddha said that patience is the highest *tapa* (burning away). It burns away the dirt in the mind.

Sumedha's picture. Sumedha thought of the earth. People throw clean things on the earth, and dirty things too. The earth bears them all. It is never angry. Sumedha said: bear honour and insult from everyone, like the earth.



"Yathāpi pathavī nāma, sucimpi asucimpi ca; sabbaṃ sahati nikkhepaṃ, na karoti paṭighaṃ tayā": Like the earth, which bears everything thrown on it, clean or unclean, and is not angry about it. (Buddhavaṃsa 2)

The story of the buffalo and the monkey. Once the *Bodhisatta* (the Buddha-to-be) was born as a great buffalo. He was big and strong, with wide horns. He lived in the forest, and he had a favourite place under a tree, where he stood and where he slept.

A monkey lived in that tree. The monkey was rude and naughty. He jumped on the buffalo's back. He sat on his shoulder, and on his forehead, and even between his horns. He pulled his ears and swung on his horns. He made a mess all over him. Not once. Day after day.

A *yakkha* (a spirit) who lived in the tree saw it all. He said to the buffalo: why put up with this? Kill him. One push with the horns, one stamp with a foot, and he is gone.

The buffalo answered: this monkey is small and weak and silly. If I were angry with him, I would be lower than he is. My *sīla* (good conduct) would break, and wise people would blame me. It is better to be laughed at and keep a clean mind than to hurt another to save my own life. And he said: if I put up with him, I will get what I am hoping for. What he was hoping for was to become a Buddha.

So the buffalo stood still. Later the monkey tried the same tricks on another buffalo, a fierce one, and that buffalo killed him. But the *Bodhisatta* (the Buddha-to-be) never hurt him.

Anna and the mosquito. It is a hot night. A mosquito whines by Anna's ear. She wants to shout. She does not. She waves it away gently. That is *khanti* (patience). It is small, as the buffalo's patience was big.

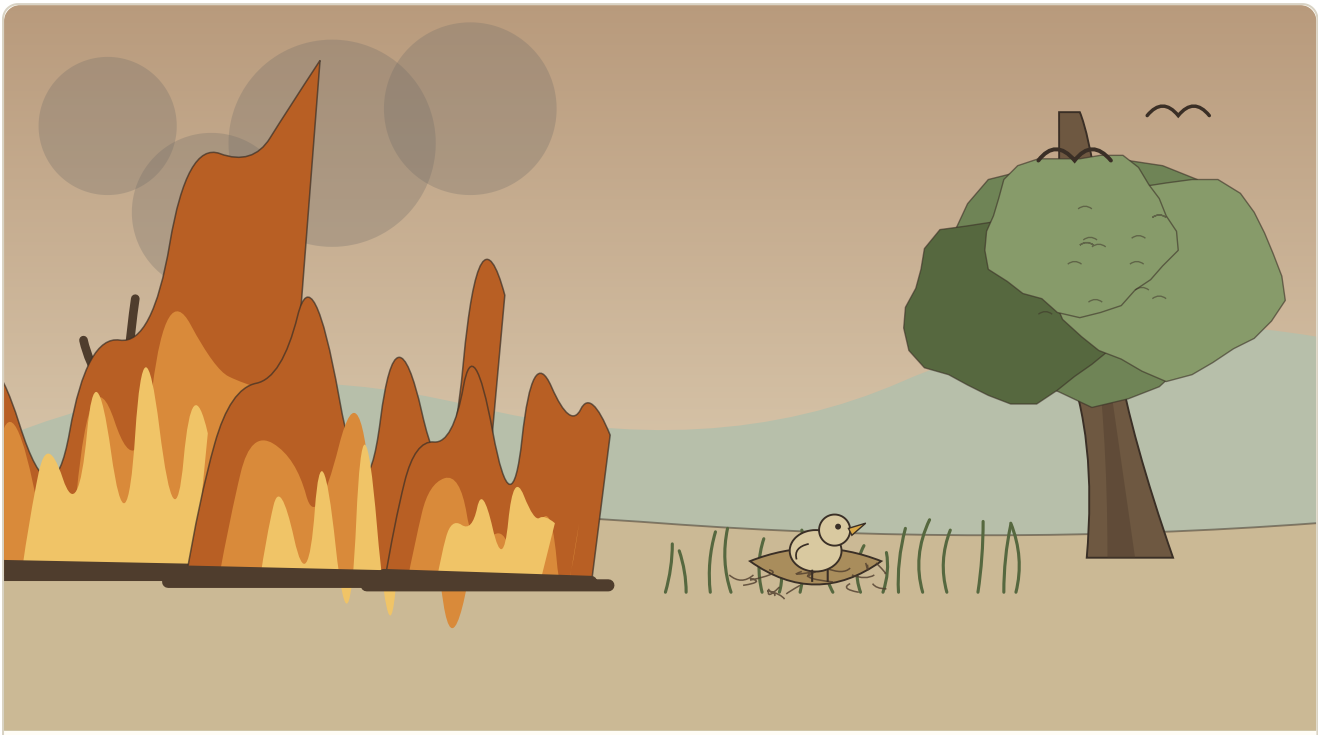
No one inside. When anger comes, it feels like "I am angry". But anger is *dosa* (anger), a visitor, like wanting. It comes up with one moment of mind, and it goes. The moment that was angry is already gone. There is nobody who has to stay angry. When that is seen, patience comes more easily. Anna says: *sabbe dhammā anattā* (all things are not self).

Quiz 3 (chapters 5 and 6)

The answers are at the back.

1. How many days did Mahājanaka swim in the sea?
    - (a) one
    - (b) seven
    - (c) a hundred
2. What was Sumedha's picture for *viriya* (energy)?
    - (a) a sleeping cat
    - (b) a lion that is never slack
    - (c) a river
3. True or false: Mahājanaka stopped swimming when the goddess said he would never reach land.
4. What did the *yakkha* (the spirit) in the tree tell the buffalo to do?
    - (a) kill the monkey
    - (b) feed the monkey
    - (c) run away
5. Why did the buffalo not hurt the monkey?
    - (a) he was afraid of the monkey
    - (b) his *sīla* (good conduct) would break, and wise people would blame him
    - (c) the monkey was his best friend
6. True or false: the Buddha said that patience is the highest *tapa* (burning away).

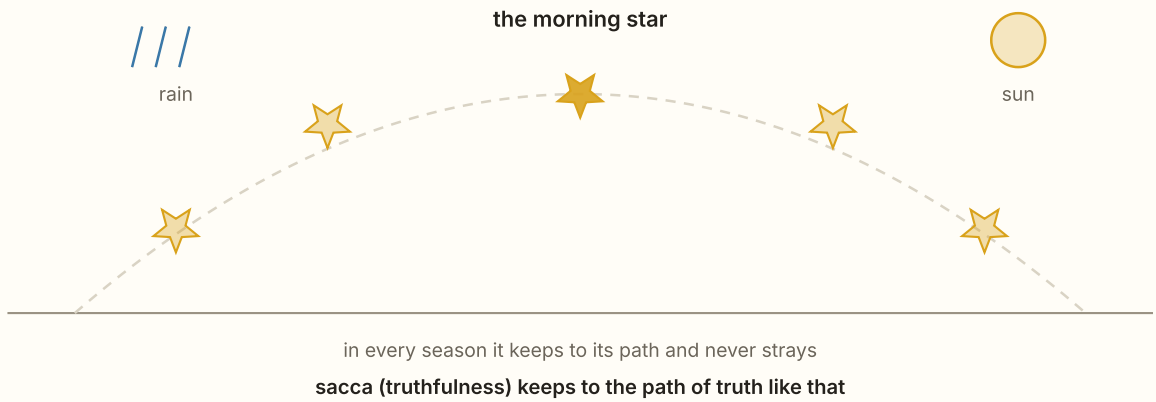
Chapter 7. Sacca (truthfulness)



"Santi pakkhā apatanā, santi pādā avañcanā; mātāpitā ca nikkhantā, jātaveda paṭikkama": I have wings, but they cannot fly. I have feet, but they cannot walk. My mother and father have gone away. Fire, go back! (Jātaka 35)

Sacca (truthfulness[1]) means telling the truth and keeping one's word. The Buddha said that truth is the sweetest of all tastes. The old books say that in some lives the *Bodhisatta* (the Buddha-to-be) broke other rules, but he never once told a lie.

Sumedha's picture. Sumedha thought of the morning star. In every season, in rain or in sun, the morning star keeps to its path across the sky. It never strays from it. Sumedha said: never stray from the path of truth.



"Yathāpi osadhī nāma, tulābhūtā sadevake; samaye utuvasse vā, na vokkamati vīthito": Like the morning star, steady for the whole world: in any season, in any weather, it never leaves its path. (Buddhavaṃsa 2)

The story of the little quail. Once the *Bodhisatta* (the Buddha-to-be) was born as a baby quail. He lay in a nest on the ground. He was tiny. His wings had no feathers yet, so he could not fly. His legs were weak, so he could not walk. His mother and father fed him from their beaks.

One hot day a fire started in the forest. It came roaring and crackling, nearer and nearer. All the birds flew away. The quail's mother and father were afraid. They flew away too, and left the baby in the nest.

The little quail thought: I have wings, but I cannot fly. I have feet, but I cannot run. My mother and father have gone. What can I do?

Then he thought: there is truth in the world. There is goodness. The Buddhas of long ago had it. By that truth I will make an act of truth.

And he said: I have wings, but they cannot fly. I have feet, but they cannot walk. My mother and father have gone away. Fire, go back!

The fire stopped. It turned back, as if it had run into water. It went out all round the nest. The old books say that nothing has burnt on that spot ever since, and nothing will, for the whole age of the world.

That is called *saccakiriyā* (an act of truth). When someone says a thing that is really true about himself, and calls on that truth, the truth has power. The quail had never told a lie, and he had never harmed anything.

Anna and the cup. Anna knocks a cup off the table. It breaks. Nobody saw. She could say she does not know how it happened. She says: I did it. That is *sacca* (truthfulness). It is hard for a moment. Then it is over, and the mind is clean.

No one inside. The deepest truth is the truth about the mind. There was seeing. There was a thought. There was fear. There was a true word. Each one came and went. No Anna inside did them all. Being truthful about that, moment by moment, is the beginning of the wisdom the Buddha taught.

HARD WORDS IN THIS CHAPTER

1. **truthfulness**: always telling the truth and keeping to it

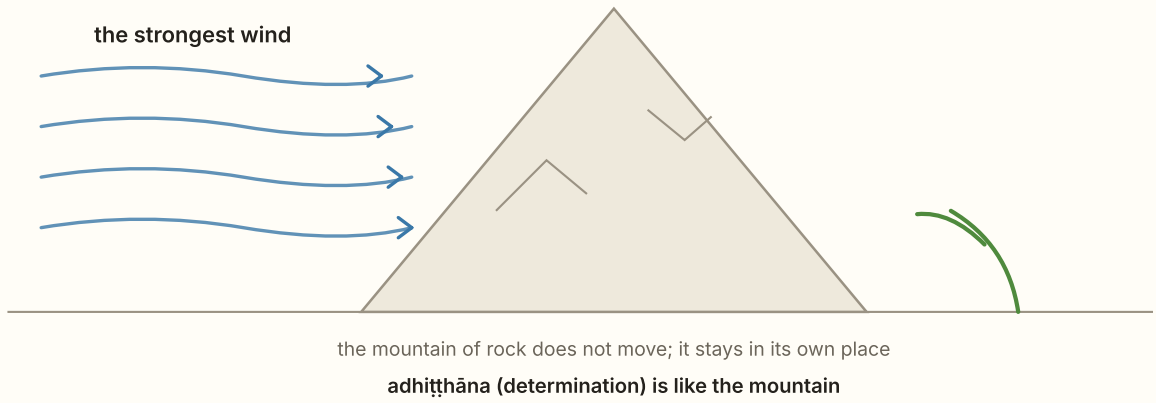
Chapter 8. Adhiṭṭhāna (determination)



"Adhiṭṭhānena me samo natthi, esā me adhiṭṭhānapāramī": In determination there was no one equal to me. This was my perfection of determination. (Cariyāpiṭaka 3.6)

Adhiṭṭhāna (determination[1]) means making up one's mind to do good and not letting go of it, even when it is very hard, and even when it takes a very long time.

Sumedha's picture. Sumedha thought of a mountain made of rock. The strongest wind blows. The mountain does not move. It stays in its own place. Sumedha said: be like that mountain in determination, always.



"Yathāpi pabbato selo, acalo suppatiṭṭhito; na kampati bhusavātehi, sakaṭṭhāneva tiṭṭhati": Like a mountain of rock, unmoving and well set: strong winds do not shake it, and it stays in its own place. (Buddhavaṃsa 2)

The story of Prince Temiya. Once the *Bodhisatta* (the Buddha-to-be) was born as a prince named Temiya. His father was the king of Kāsi. The king had waited a long time for a son, and he loved the baby very much.

When Temiya was one month old, the king held him on his lap while he judged four robbers. The king gave them terrible punishments. The baby heard it, and he was frightened. He remembered that long ago he had been a king himself, and that after that life he had gone to *niraya* (hell) because of the things he had done as king. He thought: I do not want to be king.

A *deva* (a heavenly being[2]) who lived in the royal umbrella had been his mother in a past life. She told him what to do: pretend to be a child who cannot walk, cannot hear and cannot speak. Then nobody will make him king.

So Temiya made up his mind. He lay still. He did not speak. He did not seem to hear. He did not walk.

His parents could not believe it. They tested him for sixteen years. They gave him no milk for a whole day: he did not cry. They gave him sweets and toys: he did not reach for them. They made loud noises: he did not jump. They let a big elephant come close: he did not run. They lit a fire near him: he did not move. Sixteen years. He never once let go of his plan.

At last the king gave up. He said: this boy brings bad luck. Take him to the forest and bury him.

The charioteer[3] drove Temiya to the forest and began to dig a hole. Then Temiya thought: now is my time. He stretched his arms. He stretched his legs. He stood up. He was so strong that he lifted the chariot[4] with one hand, as a boy lifts a toy. The charioteer was amazed. Temiya told him everything, and said that he would stay in the forest and live as a hermit[5].

The king and the queen came to see him. When they found him well and happy, and heard him teach, they too gave up the palace and lived in the forest.

Wishing is not deciding. A wish is light. It blows away. *Adhiṭṭhāna* (determination) is heavy, like the mountain.

Anna makes up her mind. Anna decides to say a kind word to everyone in her class, every day, for a week. On the third day she is tired and grumpy. She says the kind word anyway. That is *adhiṭṭhāna* (determination).

No one inside. Sixteen years is a long time. But Temiya did not have one self that stayed the same for sixteen years. There was a moment of firm, good mind. Then another. Then another. Each one was helped by the one before it. That is how determination works: not one big self holding on, but good moments following good moments, like steps along a road. Anna says: *sabbe dhammā anattā* (all things are not self).

HARD WORDS IN THIS CHAPTER

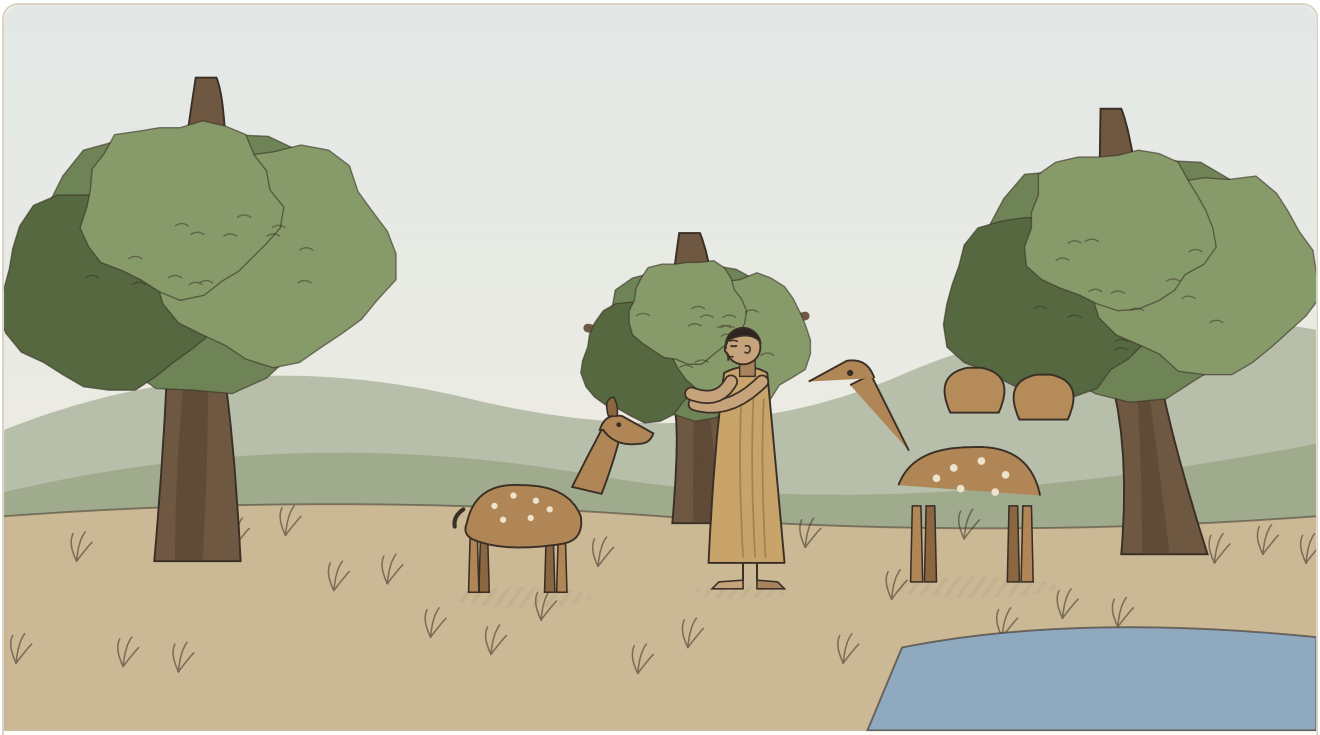
1. **determination**: making up one's mind firmly and keeping to it
2. **being**: any living creature: a person, an animal, a heavenly being
3. **charioteer**: the driver of a chariot
4. **chariot**: a cart with two wheels pulled by horses, used in old times for war and travel
5. **hermit**: a person who lives alone, away from other people

Quiz 4 (chapters 7 and 8)

The answers are at the back.

1. What did the little quail say to the fire?
    - (a) burn me
    - (b) go back
    - (c) wait for my mother
2. What was Sumedha's picture for *sacca* (truthfulness)?
    - (a) the morning star that keeps its path
    - (b) a fish
    - (c) a water pot
3. True or false: in some lives the *Bodhisatta* (the Buddha-to-be) told lies.
4. For how many years did Temiya pretend that he could not speak, hear or walk?
    - (a) one
    - (b) sixteen
    - (c) a hundred
5. What did Temiya do when the charioteer began to dig the hole?
    - (a) he cried
    - (b) he stood up and lifted the chariot
    - (c) he ran back to the palace
6. True or false: a wish is the same thing as *adhiṭṭhāna* (determination).

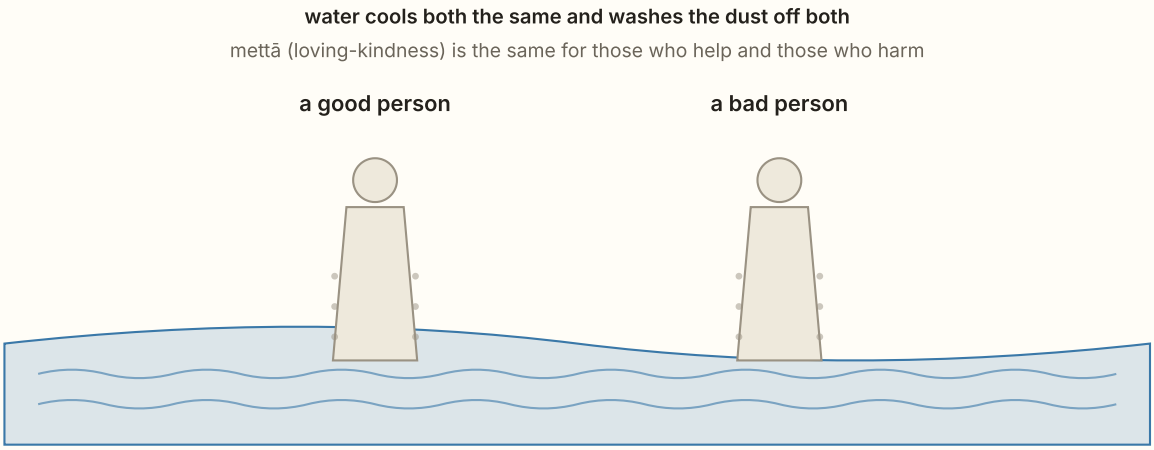
Chapter 9. Mettā (loving-kindness)



"Na maṃ koci uttasati, napi bhāyāmi kassaci; mettābalenupatthaddho, ramāmi pavane tadā": No one was afraid of me, and I was afraid of no one. Held up by the power of loving-kindness, I was happy in the forest. (Cariyāpiṭaka 3.13)

Mettā (loving-kindness[1]) means wishing others to be well and happy. All of them. Friends, and people who are not friends. People, and animals. When there is *mettā* (loving-kindness) in the mind, there is no anger in it at all. The Buddha said: as a mother would guard her only child with her own life, so let a mind of kindness go out to all beings[2], without end.

Sumedha's picture. Sumedha thought of water. Water cools a good person and a bad person just the same. It washes the dust off both. Sumedha said: have *mettā* (loving-kindness) like that, the same for those who help and for those who harm.



"Yathāpi udakaṃ nāma, kalyāṇe pāpake jane; samaṃ pharati sītena, pavāheti rajomalaṃ": Like water, which cools good people and bad people just the same, and washes away dust and dirt. (Buddhavaṃsa 2)

The story of Sāma. Once the *Bodhisatta* (the Buddha-to-be) was born as a boy named Sāma. His skin was golden, so people called him Suvaṇṇasāma, Golden Sāma. He lived in the forest with his mother and father, who were hermits[3]. When Sāma was small, an angry snake breathed poison into his parents' eyes, and they both went blind. From then on Sāma looked after them. He brought them fruit. He fetched water from the river. He washed them, and he led them by the hand.

Sāma was full of *mettā* (loving-kindness), and the animals of the forest felt it. Deer walked beside him. Lions and tigers did not hurt him. Nobody was afraid of him, and he was afraid of nobody. When he went to the river, the deer went with him, and he hung his water pots on a deer's back.

One day a king was hunting by the river. He saw a golden boy among the deer. He did not know what he was looking at. He shot an arrow with poison on it, and Sāma fell.

Even then Sāma was not angry. He asked the king one thing: who will look after my blind mother and father now? The king was sorry. He went to the parents and told them what he had done. They did not hate the king. They came to their son, and they made an act of truth on his goodness. A goddess who lived in the forest did the same. The poison left Sāma's body, and he stood up well. And his parents' eyes could see again. Then Sāma taught the king, and the king went home and ruled kindly.

Anna and the new girl. A new girl comes to Anna's class. Nobody knows her. Anna smiles at her and shows her where to sit. That is *mettā* (loving-kindness). Real *mettā* (loving-kindness) is the same for a stranger as for a friend. That is how to tell that it is real.

No one inside. Anna's kindness is not Anna. It is *mettā* (loving-kindness), a good thing that comes up with a moment of mind, warms it, and goes. And the new girl is not one solid thing either. She is body and mind moments too, coming and going, just like Anna. There is no one inside Anna

who loves, and no one inside the girl who is loved. There are moments of kindness, going out to a being who is also only moments. The Buddha taught that this is how it really is.

HARD WORDS IN THIS CHAPTER

1. **loving-kindness**: wishing others well; friendliness to everyone
2. **being**: any living creature: a person, an animal, a heavenly being
3. **hermit**: a person who lives alone, away from other people

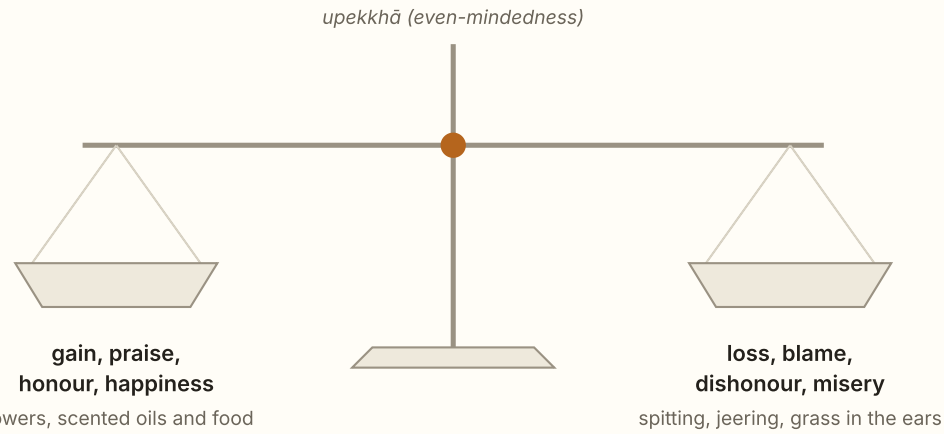
Chapter 10. Upekkhā (even-mindedness)



"Ye me dukkhaṃ upaharanti, ye ca denti sukhaṃ mama; sabbesaṃ samako homi, dayā kopo na vijjati": Those who gave me pain and those who gave me joy: to all of them I was the same. There was no favouring and no anger. (Cariyāpiṭaka 3.15)

Upekkhā (even-mindedness[1]) means a mind that stays level. Winning does not lift it up. Losing does not throw it down. Praise and blame are both only sounds in the ear. The Buddha said: as a solid rock is not moved by the wind, so the wise are not moved by blame or by praise.

Sumedha's picture. Sumedha thought of the earth again. Clean things and dirty things are thrown on it. The earth does not love the one and hate the other. It is the same to both. Sumedha said: be like that in happiness and in pain, level, like a pair of scales.



"I am impartial towards everything, and this is my perfection of equanimity."

“Selo yathā ekaghano, vātena na samīrati; evaṃ nindāpasaṃsāsu, na samiñjanti paṇḍitā”: As a solid rock is not moved by the wind, so the wise are not moved by blame or praise. (Dhammapada 81)

The story of the man who slept among the bones. Once the *Bodhisatta* (the Buddha-to-be) was a man who wanted to make *upekkhā* (even-mindedness) perfect. He went about in old clothes, and he let people think he was a fool.

He came to a village and went to the burial ground. He lay down there, and he put a dead man’s bone under his head for a pillow. The village children found him. They were rough. They spat on him. They threw dirt at him. They poked grass into his ears and laughed at him.

Other people came too, wise people. They were sorry for him. They brought him flowers and sweet-smelling oils and good food.

He was the same to all of them. He was not angry with the children. He did not love the kind people more. He said afterwards that those who gave him pain and those who gave him joy were all the same to him. In pain and in happiness, in honour and in shame, he was like a pair of scales that stays level.

Even-mindedness is not the same as not caring. The man among the bones cared about everyone. His mind was level, and it was kind.

Anna comes last. There is a race. Anna comes last. Some children laugh. Anna’s face goes hot. Then she remembers the man among the bones. Coming last is only coming last. Laughing is only a sound. She smiles and goes to get a drink of water. That is a little *upekkhā* (even-mindedness).

No one inside. A laugh is a sound. Hearing hears it. Then the hearing is gone. Then a thought comes: they are laughing at me. But there is no “me” in the sound, and no “me” in the hearing. When that is seen, the sound has nothing to hit. The mind stays level. Anna says: *sabbe dhammā anattā* (all things are not self).

HARD WORDS IN THIS CHAPTER

1. **even-mindedness**: having a mind that stays level and calm whatever happens

Quiz 5 (chapters 9 and 10)

The answers are at the back.

1. Who carried Sāma's water pots to the river?
    - (a) the king
    - (b) a deer
    - (c) his father
2. What was Sumedha's picture for *mettā* (loving-kindness)?
    - (a) water that cools good and bad people the same
    - (b) fire
    - (c) a yak
3. True or false: when the king shot him, Sāma was angry with the king.
4. What did the man among the bones use as a pillow?
    - (a) a soft cushion
    - (b) a dead man's bone
    - (c) a stone
5. How did the man among the bones feel about the rough children and the kind people?
    - (a) angry with the children and glad with the kind people
    - (b) the same to all of them
    - (c) afraid of all of them
6. True or false: *upekkhā* (even-mindedness) means not caring about anyone.

All ten together

Sumedha found the ten. The *Bodhisatta* (the Buddha-to-be) made them perfect, life after life, for a time that nobody can count. Here they are, with Sumedha's pictures and the stories.

The perfection	Sumedha's picture	The story
dāna (giving)	the full pot turned upside down	the hare who gave himself
sīla (good conduct)	the yak that guards its tail	the elephant who looked after his mother
nekkhamma (letting go)	the man who wants out of prison	Prince Yudhañjaya and the dewdrops
paññā (wisdom)	the monk who goes to every house	Mahosadha and the baby
viriya (energy)	the lion that is never slack	Mahājanaka swimming in the sea
khanti (patience)	the earth that bears everything	the buffalo and the monkey
sacca (truthfulness)	the morning star that keeps its path	the little quail and the fire
adhiṭṭhāna (determination)	the mountain that no wind can move	Prince Temiya, who did not speak
mettā (loving-kindness)	water that cools everyone the same	Sāma and the deer
upekkhā (even-mindedness)	the earth that is the same to clean and dirty	the man who slept among the bones

In every story the *Bodhisatta* (the Buddha-to-be) was not thinking "I am the good one". He was doing good. The ten are done by good moments of mind, one after another. Nobody owns them. And still they grow, and still they carry a person across the river.

The Buddha said: if a person does good, let him do it again and again. Let him find joy in it. Happy is the piling up of good.

And Anna says: *sabbe dhammā anattā* (all things are not self).

Word list

Every Pali word in this book, with the English used for it. The words are in the order of the English alphabet, ignoring the marks on the letters.

Pali	English
adhiṭṭhāna	determination
akusala	bad
anattā	not self
Aṅguttara Nikāya	the Numbered Sayings
Bodhisatta	the Buddha-to-be
Buddhavaṃsa	the Story of the Buddhas
Cariyāpiṭaka	Basket of Conduct
citta	mind
dāna	giving
deva	a heavenly being
Dhammapada	the Verses of the Teaching
dosa	anger
hiri	shame
Jātaka	birth stories
kamma	a deed
khanti	patience
kusala	good
kusala citta	good mind
lobha	wanting
Lomahaṃsa Jātaka	94
Mahā-ummagga Jātaka	546
Mahājanaka Jātaka	539
Mahiṃsa Jātaka	278
Mātuposaka Jātaka	455
mettā	loving-kindness
moha	ignorance
Mūgapakkha Jātaka	538

Pali	English
nekkhamma	letting go
nibbāna	the end of all troubles
niraya	hell
ottappa	fear of doing wrong
paññā	wisdom
pāramī	perfections
sabbe dhammā anattā	all things are not self
sacca	truthfulness
saccakiriyā	an act of truth
Sāma Jātaka	540
Saṃyutta Nikāya	the Connected Sayings
Sasapaṇḍita Jātaka	birth story 316
sīla	good conduct
Suttanipāta	the Collection of Discourses
tapa	burning away
Tipiṭaka	the Three Baskets
upekkhā	even-mindedness
Uposatha	the holy day
Vaṭṭaka Jātaka	35
viriya	energy
yakkha	a spirit
yakkhinī	a wicked spirit
Yudhañjaya Jātaka	460

Hard words

Every hard English word in this book has a small number after it the first time it is met in a chapter, and its meaning is given at the end of that chapter. Here are all of them together, in alphabetical order.

- **being**: any living creature: a person, an animal, a heavenly being
- **brahmin**: a man of the priestly class in ancient India
- **chariot**: a cart with two wheels pulled by horses, used in old times for war and travel
- **charioteer**: the driver of a chariot
- **deed**: something done; an act, good or bad
- **determination**: making up one's mind firmly and keeping to it
- **energy**: effort; the strength that keeps on going
- **even-mindedness**: having a mind that stays level and calm whatever happens
- **hermit**: a person who lives alone, away from other people
- **ignorance**: not knowing; not understanding what is really there
- **lotus**: a water flower that grows up from the mud and opens clean above the water
- **loving-kindness**: wishing others well; friendliness to everyone
- **monk**: a man who has left home to follow the Buddha's rule of life
- **nun**: a woman who has left home to follow the Buddha's rule of life
- **perfection**: a good quality made as full and strong as it can be
- **suffering**: pain and trouble; anything that cannot give lasting happiness
- **truthfulness**: always telling the truth and keeping to it

Where the stories come from

Everything in this book comes from the *Tipiṭaka* (the Three Baskets), the oldest collection of the Buddha's teaching, and from the old commentaries that explain it. Nothing has been made up. The stories are told here in short, plain words for children, and the Pali lines under the pictures are given exactly as they stand in the old books, with a plain English rendering made for this book.

Sumedha and the ten pictures. The *Buddhavaṃsa* (the Story of the Buddhas), chapter 2, the story of Sumedha. The ten pictures (the water pot, the yak, the prisoner, the monk, the lion, the earth, the morning star, the mountain, water, and the earth again) are Sumedha's own, in that chapter. The commentaries say the time he took was four uncountable ages and a hundred thousand ages. The old teachers' saying that a perfection is good conduct not spoilt by wanting, pride or the idea of a self comes from the commentary on the *Cariyāpiṭaka* (Basket of Conduct).

The stories, by chapter.

1. The wise hare: *Sasapaṇḍita Jātaka* (birth story 316) and *Cariyāpiṭaka* 1.10.
2. The elephant who looked after his mother: *Mātuposaka Jātaka* (455) and *Cariyāpiṭaka* 2.1.
3. Prince Yudhañjaya: *Yudhañjaya Jātaka* (460) and *Cariyāpiṭaka* 3.1.
4. The boy Mahosadha and the baby: *Mahā-ummagga Jātaka* (546), among the cases he judged as a child of seven.
5. Prince Mahājanaka in the sea: *Mahājanaka Jātaka* (539).
6. The buffalo and the monkey: *Mahiṃsa Jātaka* (278) and *Cariyāpiṭaka* 2.5.
7. The little quail: *Vaṭṭaka Jātaka* (35) and *Cariyāpiṭaka* 3.9.
8. Prince Temiya: *Mūgapakkha Jātaka* (538) and *Cariyāpiṭaka* 3.6.
9. Sāma: *Sāma Jātaka* (540) and *Cariyāpiṭaka* 3.13.
10. The man who slept among the bones: *Cariyāpiṭaka* 3.15 and its commentary, with the *Lomahaṃsa Jātaka* (94).

The cart. The nun Vajirā's words about the cart and the person are in the *Saṃyutta Nikāya* (the Connected Sayings) 5.10. The Buddha's words that a person who does not kill gives safety to all beings are in the *Aṅguttara Nikāya* (the Numbered Sayings), the Book of Eights.

The lines under the pictures, and the Buddha's words in the chapters. *Dhammapada* (the Verses of the Teaching) 81, 118, 184 and 279; *Suttanipāta* (the Collection of Discourses) 1.8 and 1.10; *Saṃyutta Nikāya* 1.80; *Buddhavaṃsa* chapter 2; the *Jātaka* verses of stories 35, 316, 455 and 539; and the *Cariyāpiṭaka* verses of the stories above. The Pali follows the Chaṭṭha Saṅgāyana text.

The book that inspired this one. *The Perfections Leading to Enlightenment* by Sujin Boriharnwanaket, translated from the Thai by Nina van Gorkom (Zolag, London, 2007), which can be read free of charge on abhidhamma.org.

Where the old books and modern writers differ, this book follows the old books.

Answers

Quiz 1 (chapters 1 and 2)

1. (c) his own body. The hare had only grass, so he gave himself. The fire did not burn him.
2. (a) a full pot turned upside down. The pot pours out all its water and keeps none back.
3. False. The fire felt cool to him, like cold water.
4. (b) he did not want to break his *sīla* (good conduct). He was strong enough to crush them, but fighting would have broken his good conduct.
5. (b) a yak that will not tear its tail. The yak would rather die than tear its tail. Good conduct is guarded like that.
6. True. When these two are in the mind, the rules are kept without any trouble.

Quiz 2 (chapters 3 and 4)

1. (b) dewdrops drying up in the sun. The dewdrops were there, and then they were gone. He saw that everything is like that.
2. (a) a man who wants to get out of prison. The man in prison does not love the prison. He only looks for the way out.
3. False. He loved them. He only wanted something better than the kingdom: to become a Buddha.
4. (b) the real mother let go so that the baby would not be hurt. A mother's heart is soft for her child. The *yakkhinī* (the wicked spirit) kept pulling.
5. (a) seven. He was seven years old, and already wise.
6. True. Like a lamp in a dark room, wisdom shows what is really there.

Quiz 3 (chapters 5 and 6)

1. (b) seven. He swam for seven days, with no land in sight.
2. (b) a lion that is never slack. Sitting, standing or walking, the lion is never slack, and its mind is always awake.
3. False. He said he would go on striving, as far as he could and as hard as he could.
4. (a) kill the monkey. The spirit said one push with the horns would be enough. The buffalo did not do it.
5. (b) his *sīla* (good conduct) would break, and wise people would blame him. He said that if he were angry he would be lower than the monkey.
6. True. Patience burns away the dirt in the mind.

Quiz 4 (chapters 7 and 8)

1. (b) go back. He said that his wings could not fly, his feet could not walk, and his parents had gone. Then he told the fire to go back, and it did.
2. (a) the morning star that keeps its path. In every season the morning star keeps to its path. Truth is kept like that.
3. False. He may have broken other rules in some lives, but he never told a lie.
4. (b) sixteen. Sixteen years, and he never once let go of his plan.
5. (b) he stood up and lifted the chariot. He thought: now is my time. He stood up and lifted the chariot as a boy lifts a toy.
6. False. A wish is light and blows away. Determination is heavy, like a mountain.

Quiz 5 (chapters 9 and 10)

1. (b) a deer. The deer walked with him because of his *mettā* (loving-kindness), and he hung the pots on a deer's back.
2. (a) water that cools good and bad people the same. Water cools everyone the same and washes the dust off everyone.
3. False. He only asked who would look after his blind mother and father.
4. (b) a dead man's bone. He lay in the burial ground with a bone for a pillow.
5. (b) the same to all of them. He said that those who gave him pain and those who gave him joy were all the same to him.
6. False. The man among the bones cared about everyone. His mind was level, and it was kind.